

Beyond the QA Bottleneck

Building confidence in React Native with AI



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Regressions. Every release.

We kept returning to behaviour we had already checked.

Tests existed.
Nobody ran them.

A small test suite. End-to-end checks outside CI.

More than three days of QA.

Engineering, product and UX/design.
Many people paused their own work.

Every release waited days for approval.

A chain of sign-offs held up the whole release.

Projects postponed by over a quarter.

All the existing projects had slipped by more than a quarter.



John Adib

The story of an EM in the era of AI

2× co-founder. Former CTO. Engineering leader and mentor.

18 years building and improving systems. I love moving mountains.

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01 Skills

Make good engineering habits repeatable.

01 Testing

Make each check point repeatable

02 CI

Check every PR. Make the pipeline repeatable

03 Deploy verification

Verify every PR and feature before being deployed

04 All environments

Test everything in every PR. Repeatable pipeline

05 Review

Test everything before the next deployment

06 Delivery

Test every change before being deployed

Eight skills. One development loop.

Each skill has a responsibility and an output.

cook

Coordinates the task

dig

Researches the behaviour

michelin

Implements and verifies

parole

Evaluates review feedback

sherlock

Discovers the repository

mastermind

Plans for approval

mugshot

Captures device evidence

saul

Communicates the result

My engineering standards, written down

Michelin makes those standards part of every change.

Reuse and consistency

Build on existing code, patterns and tools.

Separation of concerns

Keep UI, state and business logic focused.

Quality bar

Meaningful tests. Readable code. Verified results.

01 Skills

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02 Testing

Make each check protect real behaviour.

03

03

Check every PR. Block the pipeline on failure.

04

Check every pull request

Block the pipeline on PR and require review from others

05

PR comments

Block the pipeline on every PR. Block merge on failure

06

Review

PR comments block the PR merge pipeline

07

Delivery

PR must merge before feature deployment

The testing bar, written into the codebase

Protect what works. Raise the bar with every change.

New code needs tests

No test, no acceptance.

Bug fixes prove both cases

The test fails before the fix and passes after it.

Titles explain behaviour

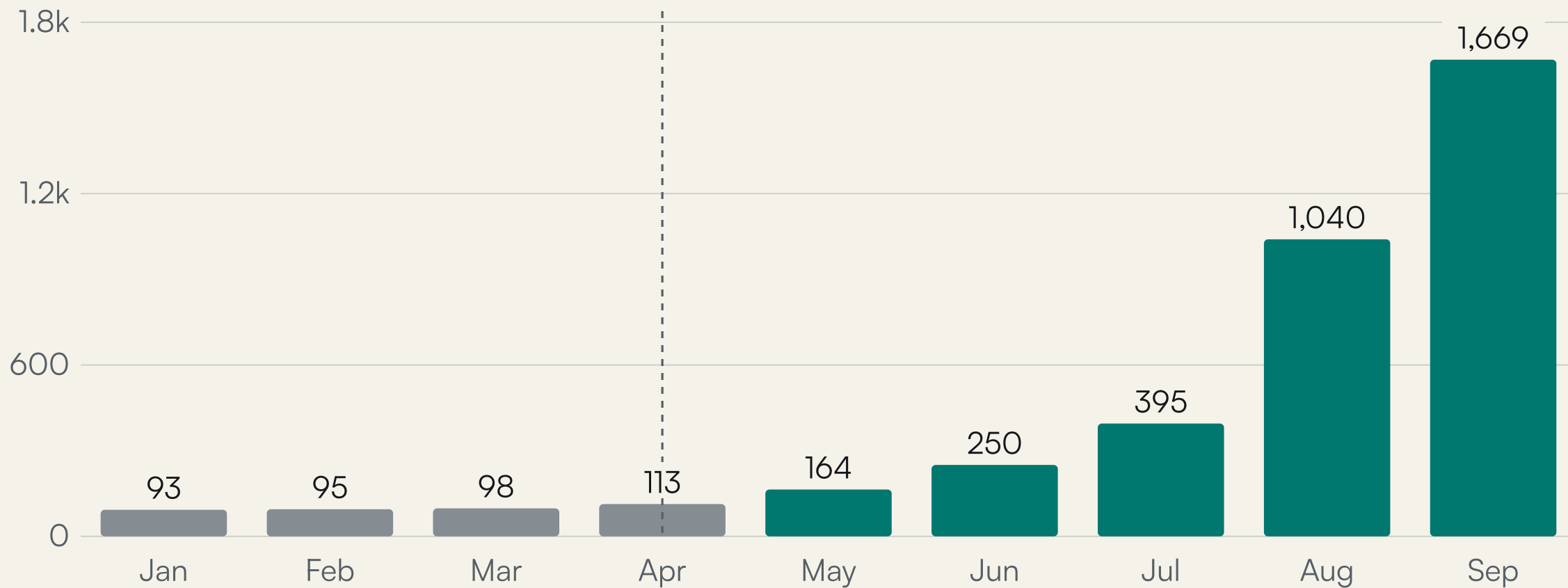
Name the expected result in plain language.

The bar keeps rising

Keep existing checks passing. Add protection as we go.

113 to 1,669 unit-test files

Joined in April 2026



Month-end test-file inventory, January to September 2026. File count does not measure coverage.

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Developer self-review

Reviewers review on PR and approve. Reviewer block ability



PR approval

PR approval or auto PR. Reviewer block ability



Review

PR approval or auto PR. Reviewer block ability



Delivery

PR approval or auto PR. Reviewer block ability

Every PR goes through CI

Failed checks block the pipeline until they pass.

Run the checks

Lint, types, tests and build on every PR.

Parole evaluates

Watch CI results. Investigate each failure.

Michelin fixes

Make the correction. Commit, push and run again.

The loop repeats until the required checks pass.

The quality bar keeps rising

72%

Line coverage, September 2026

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Maestro checks on iOS and Android. Failures block delivery.



All components

Test components on every PR. Block pipeline on failure.



Testing

Test components on every PR. Block pipeline on failure.



Delivery

Test components on every PR. Block pipeline on failure.

Maestro checks the app while we sleep

Android and iOS, with evidence of every failure.

Every PR

Run the smoke tests.

Every night

Run the full end-to-end suite.

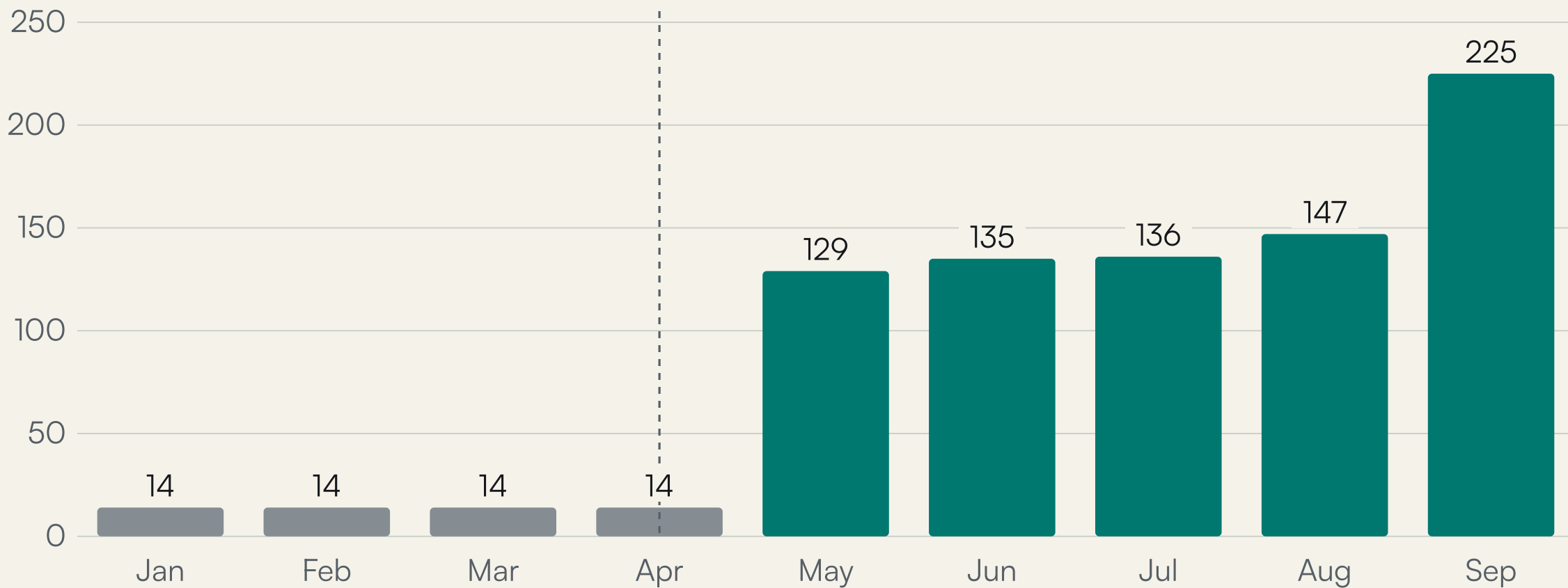
A failure blocks delivery

Fix it first. Watch the video and inspect the logs.

Attach recordings and logs so people and AI can investigate.

14 to 225 Maestro YAML files

Joined in April 2026



Month-end Maestro YAML files, January to September 2026. Includes shared flows and suites.

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05 **AI reviewers**

Three reviewers on every PR. Shared mobile guidelines.



Testing

Test automation is a key part of the engineering process.



Delivery

The team manages the release process.

Three AI reviewers. One mobile specialist.

Review feedback arrives without waiting days for a person.

CodeRabbit, Qodo, cubic

Three review perspectives on every PR.

Custom Cursor reviewer

An hourly review focused on React Native.

A shared quality bar

All reviewers use the guidelines in the repository.

Review guidelines live with the code

Every AI reviewer starts with the same mobile context.

React Native standards

Mobile best practices and platform behaviour.

Engineering expectations

Reuse existing code. Separate concerns. Require tests.

Guidelines evolve

Clarify missed context and improve future reviews.

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06 Sentry

Turn production issues into the next regression check.



Delivery

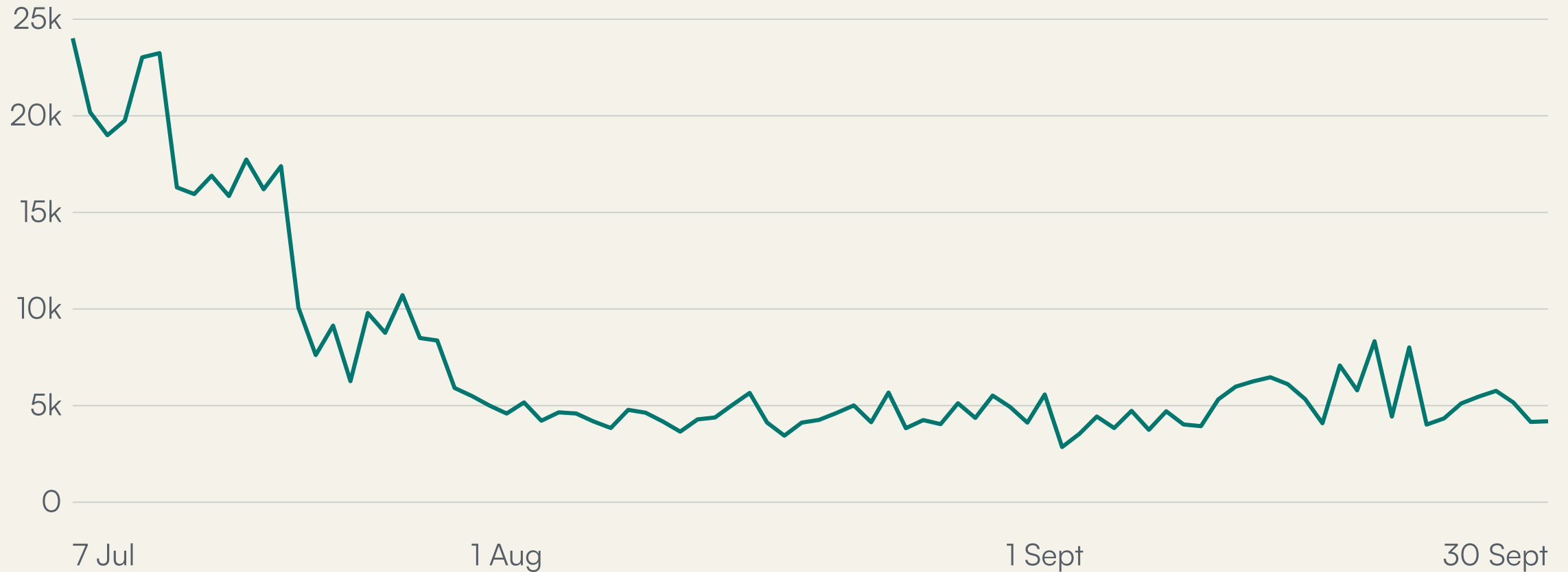
The most complex, critical feature releases

Turn an issue into a regression check

- 01 Investigate a recorded issue
- 02 Reproduce the relevant behaviour
- 03 Make a bounded correction
- 04 Add a regression check
- 05 Return evidence to review

A resurfacing issue becomes a focused development task.

Fewer recorded errors, with variation



Daily events, all environments. 7 July to 30 September 2026.
Fixes, filters and sampling affect counts. No usage denominator.

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Ship small changes. Activate features separately.

Canary builds and nightly betas

TestFlight for iOS. Test builds for Android.

After each PR

A canary build to try the change.

Every night

An automated beta build for testing.

Side by side

Install canary beside the normal app. Compare before and after.

Clear test instructions

Generated TestFlight notes explain what changed and what to test.

Release the code. Approve the flag.

Small changes ship behind feature flags.

Small increments

Keep unfinished features hidden behind a flag.

Seamless releases

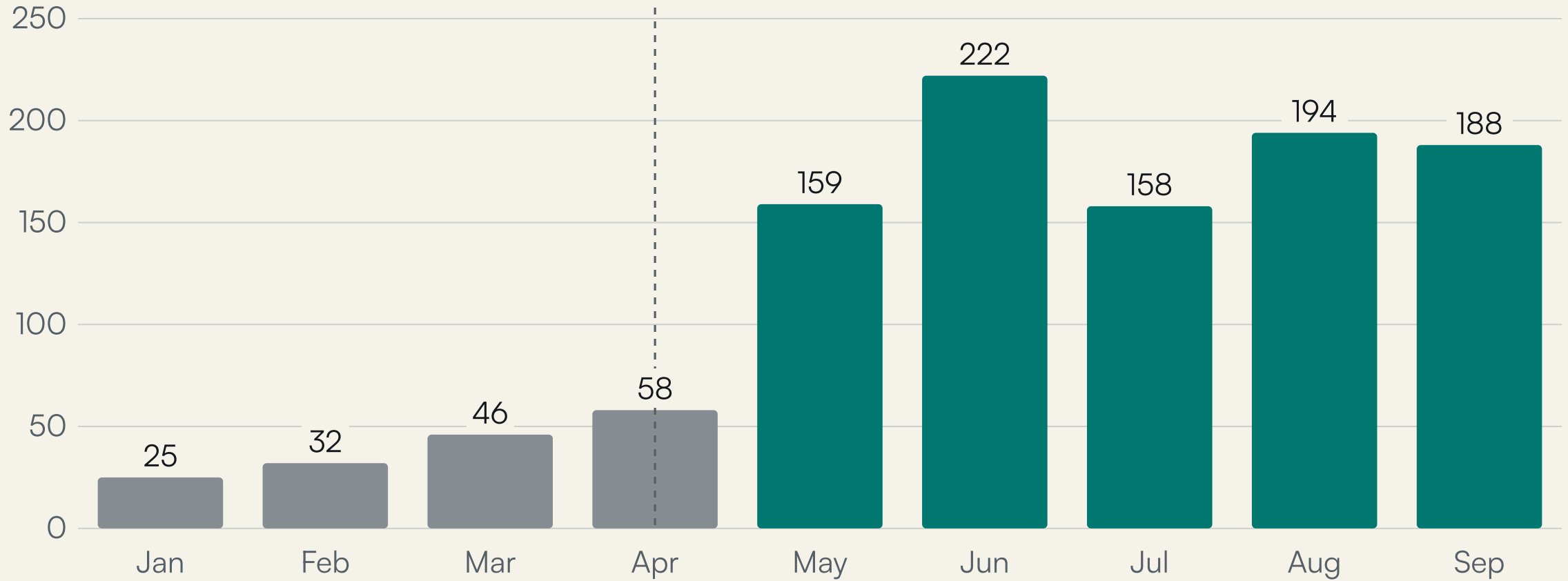
Release verified code without the feature sign-off queue.

Focused approval

Approve activating the feature when it is ready.

The development rhythm changed

Joined in April 2026



2026 app and design-system PRs across two repositories. Activity, not productivity.

There's another talk in what we left out

A few months of change across the team, codebase and business.

Design system

A shared UI language and a consistent quality bar.

Monorepo

Shared code and coordinated changes.

Ways of working

Clearer ownership and everyday engineering habits.

Product engineering

Broader ownership, from product decisions to delivery.

AI development

Adoption across planning, code, review and verification.

An AI harness

Context, skills, tools and checks around the agents.

What I'd take into another team

Find the bottleneck

Start where repeated work slows delivery.

Write down the bar

Make quality expectations clear to people and AI.

Close the feedback loop

Connect checks, evidence and fixes.

Adapt the rollout

Choose tools and release rules that fit your team.

Keep the principles. Adapt the implementation.

Confidence in AI-assisted development

Seven practices for mobile development. One continuous loop.

Skills

Repeat good engineering habits.

Testing

Protect behaviour with regression checks.

CI

Check every PR. Block failures until fixed.

Device verification

Maestro smoke and nightly checks. Video evidence.

AI reviewers

Mobile guidelines. Evaluate feedback. Fix valid issues.

Sentry

Turn production issues into regression checks.

Delivery

Canary per PR. Nightly beta. Feature flags.



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Less repetitive QA. More confidence. Faster delivery.

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